

USBR Colorado River Basin Post-2026

Section: USBR Post-2026 Overview

Source: <https://www.usbr.gov/ColoradoRiverBasin/post2026/index.html>

- Reclamation
- Colorado River Basin
- Colorado River Post 2026 Operations

Colorado River Post 2026 Operations

Several reservoir and water management decisional documents and agreements that govern the operation of Colorado River facilities and management of the Colorado River are scheduled to expire at the end of 2026. These include the 2007 Colorado River Interim Guidelines for Lower Basin Shortages and Coordinated Operations for Lake Powell and Lake Mead (2007 Interim Guidelines), the 2019 Drought Contingency Plans, as well as international agreements between the United States and Mexico pursuant to the United States-Mexico Treaty on Utilization of Waters of the Colorado and Tijuana Rivers and of the Rio Grande (1944 Water Treaty).

The Post-2026 process is a multi-year NEPA process that will identify a range of alternatives and determine operations for Lake Powell and Lake Mead and other water management actions for potentially decades into the future.

Announcements and Events

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Colorado River Post 2026 Operations

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Draft Environmental Impact Statement On January 9, 2026, Reclamation released the Post-2026 Operational Guidelines and Strategies for Lake Powell and Lake Mead – Draft Environmental Impact Statement (EIS) for public download. The formal public review and comment period begins on January 16, 2026 after publication in the Federal Register Notice and ends on March 2, 2026. Reclamation will hold two virtual public meetings to provide information on the Draft EIS. For more information on the document and public involvement process, visit the Draft EIS page.

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Alternatives Report On January 17, 2025, Reclamation published an Alternatives Report documenting the alternatives Reclamation publicly released on November 20, 2024, and anticipates carrying forward for analysis in the draft EIS, which is currently under development. The report also describes, in general terms, the process undertaken by Reclamation to develop the alternatives, provides a detailed description of the operational elements for each alternative, and compares the operational elements across each alternative. [Read More →](#)

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Reclamation provides an update on Post-2026 process and alternatives at Colorado River Water Users Association Meeting Dec. 5, 2024 Reclamation's Carly Jerla provided an update on Lake Powell & Lake Mead Operations Post-2026. [View presentation](#)

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Status Update Webinar-Alternatives Development Reclamation held a webinar on Thursday, October 10, 2024, to provide a status update on the Post-2026 Process, including an overview of the ongoing work to develop NEPA alternatives.

Webinar Presentation

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Integrated Technical Education Workgroup Session #6 - Web Tool Operational Paradigms and Uncertainties Follow Up; November 2, 2023 This session describes the role of alternative paradigms in the Post-2026 Operations Exploration Tool (Web Tool) and explains the concepts and levers that can be combined into 48 customizable paradigms in the Web Tool strategy creation interface. It also reviews the approach to representing uncertainty in hydrology, demands, and initial conditions in Web Tool modeling and describes the specific inputs chosen for each category. The webinar materials are available for review.

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Scoping Summary Report, Purpose and Need, Proposed Federal Action Reclamation published a Federal Register Notice announcing the availability of the Scoping Summary Report for the Post-2026 Process. The Scoping Summary Report provides a summary of the comments received during the public scoping process and describes the Department's current, preliminary assessment of the proposed federal action, purpose and need, and scope of the environmental analysis to be included in the draft environmental impact statement (DEIS). [Read More →](#)

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Integrated Technical Education Workgroup Session #5 - Metrics, Tradeoffs, Robustness and Vulnerability; September 20, 2023 This session features academic experts from University of Colorado, Boulder, who describe the specific DMDU approach being used in the post-2026 alternatives development process. It also provides information about how Reclamation will approach specific analytical components in the Post-2026 Web Tool. The webinar materials are available for review.

Public Comments on the Draft EIS Available

On March 2, 2026, the 45-day public review and comment period for the Draft EIS concluded. Reclamation hosted two public meetings and received 18,127 submissions. There were 785 unique submissions from the public, tribes, states, federal agencies, non-governmental organizations, and other stakeholders, over 17,000 form letters, over 5,000 form letters with unique content, and 51 duplicate submissions. Videos of the public meetings and the public comments can be viewed on the Draft EIS Public Review and Comment Process page.

If there are questions or you would like to submit a comment, please email: crbpost2026@usbr.gov.

Disclaimer: English is the official language and authoritative version of all federal information.

Section: Draft EIS

Source: <https://www.usbr.gov/ColoradoRiverBasin/post2026/draft-eis/index.html>

- Reclamation
- Colorado River Basin
- Colorado River Post 2026 Operations
- Colorado River Post 2026 Operations — Draft EIS

Post-2026 Operational Guidelines and Strategies for Lake Powell and Lake Mead – Draft Environmental Impact Statement

Reclamation released the Post-2026 Operational Guidelines and Strategies for Lake Powell and Lake Mead – Draft Environmental Impact Statement. A Notice of Availability of the Draft EIS was published in the Federal Register on January 16, 2026, for a 45-day public review and comment period that ended March 2, 2026.

Additionally, Reclamation developed an interactive tool designed to allow for easy comparison of figures across the Post-2026 Draft EIS. This tool can be accessed here: [CRB Post-2026 Draft EIS Figure Viewer](#)

For tool assistance, email: crbpost2026@usbr.gov

Executive Summary (7.8 MB, PDF)

Volume 1 – Main Body

- Cover, Abstract, Table of Contents, and Acronyms (2.72 MB, PDF)
- Chapter 1 - Purpose and Need (2.6 MB, PDF)
- Chapter 2 - Description of Alternatives (943 KB, PDF)
- Chapter 3 - Affected Environment and Environmental Consequences (5 MB, PDF)
- Chapter 4 - Consultation and Coordination (228 KB, PDF)
- Preparers, References, Glossary, and Index (738 KB, PDF)

Volume 2 – Supporting Appendices

- Cover, Table Of Contents (713 KB, PDF)
- A. CRSS Model Documentation (3.6 MB, PDF)
- B. Modeling Assumptions: Lake Powell and Lake Mead Storage and Delivery of Conserved Water (805 KB, PDF)
- C. Shortage Allocation Model and Alternative Distribution Model Documentation (5.8 MB, PDF)
- D. Sensitivity Analysis - Effects of Natural Flow Percentage Used for the Supply Driven Alternative (522 KB, PDF)
- E. DMDU Overview and Approach (353 KB, PDF)
- F. Approach to Hydrologic Uncertainty (1 MB, PDF)
- G. CRSS Initial Conditions (826 KB, PDF)
- H. Sensitivity Analysis - Effects of Demand Schedule Assumptions on Modeled Unused Tribal Water Available for Storage in the Enhanced Coordination Alternative (546 KB, PDF)
- I. Sensitivity Analysis – Effects of Alternate Upper Basin Demand Scenarios on Operations at Lake Powell and Lake Mead (5.5 MB, PDF)
- J. Sensitivity Analysis - Effects of Assumed Parameter Values on 602(a) Storage (353 KB, PDF)
- K. Sensitivity Analysis - Effects of Modeling Assumptions with Regard to Future Water Deliveries to Mexico (871 KB, PDF)
- L. Upper Basin States Depletion Schedules (217 KB, PDF)
- M. International Border Region of the Colorado River (4.6 MB, PDF)
- N. Lower Division States Depletion Schedules (872 KB, PDF)

- O. Analysis of Powell Infrastructure Protection Releases (547 KB, PDF)

Volume 3 – Technical Appendices

- Cover, Table of Contents (680 KB, PDF)
- TA-3: Hydrologic Resources (6.6 MB, PDF)
- TA-4: Water Deliveries (4.9 KB, PDF)
- TA-5: Geomorphology and Sediment (2.3 MB, PDF)
- TA-6: Water Quality (1.9 MB, PDF)
- TA-7: Air Quality (3.3 MB, PDF)
- TA-8: Fish and Aquatic Resources (10.4 MB, PDF)
- TA-9: Vegetation (3.4 MB, PDF)
- TA-10: Terrestrial Wildlife (900 KB, PDF)
- TA-11: Cultural Resources (1.3 MB, PDF)
- TA-12: Paleontological Resources (20 MB, PDF)
- TA-13: Tribal Resource (400 KB, PDF)
- TA-14: Recreation (1.1 MB, PDF)
- TA-15: Dams and Electrical Power Resources (4.1 MB, PDF)
- TA-16: Socioeconomics (3.1 MB, PDF)
- TA 17: Population and Land Use (1.7 MB, PDF)
- TA 18: Indian Trust Assets (3.9 MB, PDF)
- TA 19: Visual Resources (1 MB, PDF)

Section: Public Review

Source: <https://www.usbr.gov/ColoradoRiverBasin/post2026/draft-eis/Public-Review-Comment-Process.html>

- Reclamation
- Colorado River Basin
- Colorado River Post 2026 Operations
- Colorado River Post 2026 Operations — Draft EIS

Post-2026 Operational Guidelines and Strategies for Lake Powell and Lake Mead

Draft EIS Public Review and Comment Process

Reclamation held two virtual public meetings to provide information on the Draft EIS. Recordings and presentation materials for each meeting are available to view below.

Virtual Meetings

Public Meeting, February 10, 2026

Download English Presentation (PDF 6.1 MB) Download Spanish Presentation (PDF, 12.8 MB)

Public Meeting, January 29, 2026

[Download English Presentation](#) - [Download \(PDF 6.1 MB\)](#) [Download Spanish Presentation](#) - [Download \(PDF, 12.8 MB\)](#)

Public Comments

Reclamation received 18,127 submissions during the Draft EIS comment period, including 785 unique submissions from the public, tribes, states, federal agencies, non-governmental organizations, and other stakeholders, over 17,000 form letters, over 5,000 form letters with unique content, and 51 duplicate submissions. Unique submissions are available for review below. All public comments are retained in the project record.

- Arizona Department of Water Resources
- Colorado River Authority of Utah
- Colorado River Board of California
- Colorado Water Conservation Board
- New Mexico Interstate Stream Commission
- Southern Nevada Water Authority
- Wyoming State Engineers Office

Tribes

- Ak-Chin Indian Community
- Chemehuevi Indian Tribe
- Cocopah Indian Tribe
- Colorado River Indian Tribes
- Fort McDowell Yavapai Nation
- Fort Mojave Indian Tribe
- Fort Yuma Quechan Indian Tribe
- Gila River Indian Community
- Havasupai Tribe
- Hopi Tribe
- Hualapai Tribe
- Jicarilla Apache Nation
- Kaibab Band of Paiute Indians
- Navajo Nation
- Pascua Yaqui Tribe
- San Carlos Apache Tribe
- San Luis Rey Indian Water Authority
- Southern Ute Indian Tribe
- Tohono O'odham Nation
- Tohono O'odham Nation, San Xavier District
- Ute Indian Tribe of the Uintah and Ouray Reservation

- Ute Mountain Ute Tribe
- Yavapai-Apache Nation

Federal Agencies

- National Park Service
- US Environmental Protection Agency
- US Fish and Wildlife Service
- Western Area Power Administration

Non-Governmental Organizations

- Alliance for Water Efficiency
- American Rivers, Environmental Defense Fund, National Audubon Society, Nature Conservancy, Theodore Roosevelt Conservation Partnership, Trout Unlimited, Western Resource Advocates
- American Whitewater
- Amphibian Refuge
- Andy Shrader, Paul Koretz, John Wick, Anthony Mynt, Calla Rose Ostrander
- Aydee Rodriguez, Eric Montoya Reyes, Sandra Ramirez, Suguet Lopez, Isabella Arzeno Soltero, Ryan Sinclair, Daniela Flores, Mara Freilich
- Center for Biological Diversity
- Club20
- Glen Canyon Institute
- Grand Canyon Private Boaters Association
- Grand Canyon River Guides
- Grand Canyon Trust
- Great Basin Water Network, Living Givers Colorado Riverkeeper, River Runners for Wilderness
- Green Latinos
- June Sucker Recovery Implementation Program
- Los Angeles Waterkeeper
- National Parks Conservation Association
- Pacific Institute
- Returning Rapids Project
- San Xavier Allottees Association
- Sierra Club Colorado River
- Sonoran Institute
- Southwest Wildlands
- The Affiliated Ute Citizens of the State of Utah
- Tortolita Alliance
- Upper Green River Alliance

- Water Fairness Coalition Inc.

- Waterkeeper Alliance

Local Entities

- Albuquerque Bernalillo County Water Utility Authority

- Arizona Game and Fish Department

- Arizona Municipal Water Users Association

- Arizona Power Authority, Arizona Municipal Power Users' Association, Grand Canyon State Electric Cooperative Association, Inc., Irrigation and Electric Districts Association of Arizona

- Bard Water District

- Central Arizona Project

- Central Utah Water Conservancy District

- Cibola Valley Irrigation and Drainage District

- City of Bullhead

- City of Chandler

- City of Escondido and Vista Irrigation District

- City of Española

- City of Glendale

- City of Goodyear

- City of Mesa

- City of Needles

- City of Phoenix

- City of Poway

- City of Santa Fe

- City of Scottsdale

- City of Tucson

- City of Yuma

- Coachella Valley Water District

- Coalition of Local Governments

- Colorado River Water Conservation District

- Delta County Commissioners

- Desert Water Agency

- Dolores Water Conservancy District

- Eagle County Colorado

- Emery Water Conservancy District

- Front Range Water Council

- Garfield County

- Grand County Commissioners
- Grand Valley Water Users Association
- Gunnison County Commissioners
- Imperial Irrigation District
- Jordan Valley Water Conservancy District
- Lincoln County Commissioners
- Maricopa County Parks and Recreation
- Metropolitan Domestic Water Improvement District
- Moffat County Commissioners
- Mohave County Board of Supervisors
- Mohave County Water Authority
- Mojave Groundwater Bank
- Mohave Valley Irrigation and Drainage District
- Northern Colorado Water Conservancy District
- Northwest Colorado Council of Governments
- Orchard Mesa Irrigation District
- Palo Verde Irrigation District
- Pitkin County Commissioners
- Provo River Water Users Association
- Rio Blanco County Commissioners
- Salt River Project Agricultural Improvement and Power District and Salt River Valley Water Users' Association
- Salton Sea Authority
- San Diego County Water Authority
- San Juan Water Commission
- Santa Fe Irrigation District
- Southwestern Water Conservation District
- Strawberry Water Users Association
- Sublette County Commission
- Summit County Commissioners
- The Metropolitan Water District of Southern California
- Town of Cave Creek
- Town of Gilbert
- Town of Marana
- Town of Queen Creek

- Uintah Water Conservancy District
- Upper Colorado River Commission
- Upper Gunnison River Water Conservancy District
- Ute Water Conservancy District
- Vallecitos Water District
- Washington County Water Conservancy District
- Water Infrastructure Finance Authority of Arizona
- Yuma Area Irrigation District
- Yuma City Council
- Yuma County Water Users' Association
- Yuma Mesa Irrigation and Drainage District

Academic/Research

- Anne Castle, John Fleck, R. Eric Kuhn, John C. Schmidt, Katherine Tara, Kathryn Sorensen
- Brittany Fager, Anabelle Myers, Erik Porse, David Rosenberg
- Utah State University College of Engineering

Elected Officials

- Arizona Congressional Delegation Biggs et al.
- Arizona Senate Congressional Delegation Kelly et al.
- Arizona State Legislature
- US Representative Dina Titus
- US Representative Greg Stanton

Resource-Sector & Business Interests

- Arizona Chamber of Commerce & Industry
- Arizona Farm Bureau Federation
- Arizona Mining Association
- Arizona Public Service Company
- Arizona Water Company
- ASARCO LLC
- Circle C Ranches
- Colorado River Energy Distributors Association
- EPCOR USA
- Freeport McMoRan
- Greater Phoenix Economic Council
- Guide Water
- Home Builders Association of Central Arizona

- Imperial County Farm Bureau, Imperial Valley Vegetable Growers Association, Imperial Valley Water
- Platte River Power Authority
- Protect CO Ag Water Coalition
- Southern Arizona Home Builders Association
- Stratecon Inc.
- Transoceanic LLC
- Uncompahgre Valley Water Users Association
- Western States Ranches

Individual

More than 200 individuals submitted unique comments. These submissions were organized alphabetically using the first initial of each commenter's last name.

Form Letters

Form letters are submittals from multiple entities or individuals containing identical or similar content. Reclamation received 25 form letter submissions from more than 17,000 senders. Reclamation also received more than 5,000 form letter submissions with additional unique content. Additional information on the number of submitters is included on the cover letter for each form letter in the document below.

Disclaimer: English is the official language and authoritative version of all federal information.

Last Updated: 4/21/26

Section: Alternatives Development

Source: <https://www.usbr.gov/ColoradoRiverBasin/post2026/alternatives/index.html>

- Reclamation
- Colorado River Basin
- Colorado River Post 2026 Operations
- Colorado River Post 2026 Operations — Alternatives Development

Alternatives Development — Colorado River Post 2026 Operations

Overview

The goal of the alternatives development phase of this National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) process is to provide a reasonable and broad range of alternatives for managing the Colorado River system and its resources post-2026.

The objectives associated with analyzing a sufficiently broad range of alternatives are two-fold:

- Ensuring that decision-makers and the public are informed of all potential impacts and tradeoffs of different operational approaches
- Providing analysis for the components that may eventually make up the Preferred Alternative in the Final EIS

The process of developing the range of alternatives started in 2022 and has been informed by solicitation of input and extensive collaborative engagement with stakeholders throughout the Basin. It is anticipated that the alternatives will continue to be refined through additional input from stakeholders,

and public review and comment on the draft environmental impact statement (EIS).

Alternative Development Process

Reclamation kicked off alternative development by soliciting input on considerations for alternatives during the pre-scoping and scoping periods in 2022 and 2023. Comments during this time included specific alternatives, different operational proposals, and resource considerations. This input was captured in the Scoping Report for Post-2026 Colorado River Operations (8 MB, PDF) (October 2023).

Since scoping, Reclamation continued to solicit input, resulting in considerable information from the Basin States (Arizona, California, Colorado, Nevada, New Mexico, Utah, and Wyoming), many Basin Tribes, conservation organizations, other federal agencies, other stakeholders, and members of the public (submittals are posted below). Input ranged from detailed proposed alternatives to operational concepts and principles.

Reclamation conducted an extensive engagement process, including conducting over 100 meetings with states, tribes, and other partners to review and discuss their input. For those proposals containing sufficient detail to be considered as a full alternative or a major component of an alternative, Reclamation worked extensively with these entities to not only understand and gather additional information, but also to model and perform preliminary analyses of their proposals to facilitate refinements.

Reclamation continued to inform the public on the status of alternatives development by conducting a public webinar in October 2024, released preliminary alternative concepts (200 KB, PDF) on November 20, 2024, and published an Alternative Development Report.

Alternatives Development Report

On January 17, 2025, Reclamation published the Alternatives Report (3 MB, PDF) to document the preliminary alternatives that were publicly released on November 20, 2024. The five alternatives identified in the report provided a reasonable and broad range of Colorado River operations that would capture an appropriate range of potential environmental impacts from implementing new operational guidelines post-2026. The report also described, in general terms, the process undertaken by Reclamation to develop the alternatives, provided a detailed description of the operational elements for each alternative, and compared the operational elements across each alternative.

Reclamation released the report to enhance transparency and inform the public, partners, and stakeholders of the alternative operations being considered at the time. The report also served to help foster additional collaboration in the refinement of the alternatives that were eventually included in the Draft EIS.

Post-2026 Operations Exploration Web Tool

To facilitate public understanding and input on the alternatives, Reclamation developed and released in December 2023, the Post-2026 Operations Exploration Web Tool, an online platform that allows stakeholders, interested parties and the public to independently or collaboratively design, model and explore a wide range of creative operational strategies. Use of the platform is not considered formal input to the Post-2026 Process, but insights from the 500-plus operational strategies entered into the platform were used to inform alternatives.

Draft EIS Alternatives

Through the alternatives development process described above, the following five alternatives (No Action and four action alternatives) were selected to be analyzed in detail in the Draft EIS. The alternatives are described in detail in Chapter 2 of the Draft EIS.

- No Action Alternative
- Basic Coordination Alternative (formerly the Federal Authorities Alternative)

- Enhanced Coordination Alternative (formerly the Federal Authorities Hybrid Alternative)
- Maximum Operational Flexibility Alternative (formerly the Cooperative Conservation Alternative)
- Supply Driven Alternative

Received Alternatives Input

Beginning in early 2024, Reclamation received input from Basin partners and stakeholders with proposals and considerations for alternatives. Submissions received through November 20, 2024, are included below by date received and submitter.

- March 5, 2024 - Colorado River Upper Division State Representatives of Colorado, New Mexico, Utah, and Wyoming
- March 6, 2024 - The Colorado River Basin States Representatives of Arizona, California, and Nevada
- March 6, 2024 - Central Arizona Water Conservation District, Southern Nevada Water Authority, and The Metropolitan Water District of Southern California
- March 29, 2024 - National Audubon Society, Western Resource Advocates, Theodore Roosevelt Conservation Partnership, American Rivers, The Nature Conservancy, Environmental Defense Fund, and Trout Unlimited
- March 29, 2024 - Center for Colorado River Studies, Eric Kuhn, and Utton Center, University of New Mexico School of Law
- March 29, 2024 - Gila River Indian Community
- April 29, 2024 - U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service and National Park Service
- May 8, 2024 - City of Phoenix
- May 16, 2024 - Southern Ute Indian Tribe, Paiute Indian Tribe of Utah, Salt River Pima–Maricopa Indian Community, Ute Mountain Ute Tribe, Tonto Apache Tribe, Fort Yuma Quechan Indian Tribe, Pueblo of Zuni Tribe, Gila River Indian Community, Yavapai-Apache Nation, Ak Chin Indian Community, Ute Indian Tribe, Jicarilla Apache Nation, Yavapai-Prescott Indian Tribe, Hualapai Tribe, Las Vegas Tribe of Paiute, San Juan Southern Paiute Tribe, San Carlos Apache Tribe, Chemehuevi Tribe, White Mountain Apache Tribe, and Pasqua Yaqui Tribe
- June 3, 2024 - Department of Energy, Western Area Power Administration, Colorado River Storage Project
- November 12, 2024 - Colorado River Indian Tribes

Section: Scoping Summary

Source: <https://www.usbr.gov/ColoradoRiverBasin/post2026/scoping/index.html>

- Reclamation
- Colorado River Basin
- Colorado River Post 2026 Operations
- Colorado River Post 2026 Operations — Pre-Scoping

Notice: English is the official language and authoritative version of all federal information.

Scoping — Colorado River Post 2026 Operations

Notice of Intent and Request for Comments

The Bureau of Reclamation announced its intent to prepare an Environmental Impact Statement for post-2026 operations on June 16 and solicited public comments on the scope of specific operational guidelines, strategies, and any other related issues that should be considered in the upcoming Environmental Impact Statement. The Notice of Intent was published in the Federal Register on June 16, 2023, and Reclamation accepted comments through August 15, 2023. Reclamation published a Scoping Summary Report in October 2023.

Public Meetings

Reclamation held three public scoping webinars to provide summary information and solicit public scoping comments on the development of Post-2026 Operational Guidelines and Strategies for Lake Powell and Lake Mead. The scoping webinar presentation and recordings are available for review. Each meeting presentation covered the same information. The public comment portions of the meetings varied based on the public participants at each meeting.

- Monday, July 17, 2023, 1 p.m. to 2 p.m. (MDT) – Webinar Recording
- Tuesday, July 18, 2023, 10 a.m. to 11 a.m. (MDT) – Webinar Recording
- Monday, July 24, 2023, 6 p.m. to 7 p.m. (MDT) – Webinar Recording

Presentación del webinar (En Español)

Scoping Comments

Reclamation received 24,290 comment submissions during the scoping period, including 318 unique comment submissions from the public, Tribes, states, federal agencies, non-governmental organizations, and other stakeholders, 21,658 form letters, 1,256 form letters with unique content, and 1,058 duplicate submissions.

This input was used to develop the proposed federal action, which allows for developing robust operating guidelines for Lake Powell and Lake Mead without precluding upstream or downstream activities needed to protect critical reservoir elevations at Lake Powell and Lake Mead. The action also is intended to allow for the development of innovative and flexible operating guidelines that provide improved predictability of water availability and enhanced opportunities for conservation.

Reclamation made unique comment submissions from the scoping period available for review.

Scoping Summary Report

The Scoping Summary Report provides a summary of the comments received during the public scoping process and describes the Department's current, preliminary assessment of the proposed federal action and purpose and need.

Reclamation provided an overview of the comments received during the scoping period and reviewed the preliminary assessment of the proposed federal action and the draft purpose and need at an informational webinar on October 24, 2023.

Announcements

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Scoping Summary Report, Purpose and Need, Proposed Federal ActionReclamation published a Federal Register Notice announcing the availability of the Scoping Summary Report for the Post-2026 Process. The Scoping Summary Report provides a summary of the comments received during the public scoping process and describes the Department's current, preliminary assessment of the proposed federal action, purpose and need, and scope of the environmental analysis to be included in the draft environmental impact statement (DEIS).

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Scoping Period Closed, Reclamation reviewing input receivedReclamation recently held a 60-day scoping period from June 16, 2023, to August 15, 2023. Reclamation received more than 21,000 comment submissions during the scoping period, including comments from the public, basin Tribes, basin states, federal agencies, non-governmental organizations, and other stakeholders. Reclamation is reviewing the comments and anticipates publishing a scoping report later this fall.

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Interior Department Initiates Process to Develop Future Guidelines and Strategies for Protecting the Colorado RiverJune 15, 2023 – The Department of the Interior today announced that it is initiating the formal process to develop future operating guidelines and strategies to protect the stability and sustainability of the Colorado River. The new guidelines will replace the 2007 Colorado River Interim Guidelines for Lower Basin Shortages and the Coordinated Operations for Lake Powell and Lake Mead, which are set to expire at the end of 2026. Read More →

Section: Integrated Technical Education Workgroup

Source: <https://www.usbr.gov/ColoradoRiverBasin/post2026/itew.html>

- Reclamation
- Colorado River Basin
- Colorado River Post 2026 Operations
- Internal Technical Education Workgroup

Integrated Technical Education Workgroup

The Integrated Technical Education Workgroup (ITEW) was created to ensure that Colorado River partners have a common and accurate understanding of the underlying tools and concepts needed to meaningfully participate in the development of Post-2026 operating alternatives. The goal of the ITEW is to assist interested partners from across the Basin to gain a better understanding of the technical tools and approaches that we anticipate using in the Post-2026 Process. Participants include Tribes, States, municipalities, water and irrigation districts, non-governmental organizations, and other Federal agencies. Through the ITEW, Reclamation offers education about the models, data, and concepts used frequently in its studies, and shares information specifically about the technical framework that will support the Post-2026 Process.

Meetings and Webinars

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Integrated Technical Education Workgroup Session #6 - Web Tool Operational Paradigms and Uncertainties Follow UpThis session describes the role of alternative paradigms in the Post-2026 Operations Exploration Tool (Web Tool) and explains the concepts and levers that can be combined into 48 customizable paradigms in the Web Tool strategy creation interface. It also reviews the approach to representing uncertainty in hydrology, demands, and initial conditions in Web Tool modeling and describes the specific inputs chosen for each category.

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Integrated Technical Education Workgroup Session #5 - Metrics, Tradeoffs, Robustness and Vulnerability; September 20, 2023This session features academic experts from University of Colorado, Boulder, who describe the specific DMDU approach being used in the post-2026 alternatives development process. It also provides information about how Reclamation will approach specific analytical components in the Post-2026 Web Tool.

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Integrated Technical Education Workgroup Session #4 - Demands; August 2, 2023 This meeting describes how projections of future demands are created and used in official Colorado River Simulation System (CRSS) modeling and how demands and other inputs will be handled in the Post-2026 Web Tool. Reclamation then provides additional information about hydrology and is joined by researchers from Utah State University who present a newly developed hydrology ensemble.

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Integrated Technical Education Workgroup Session #3 - Hydrology; June 23, 2023 Hydrology in the Colorado River Basin is a complex and challenging system to monitor and model. This meeting provides an overview of historical hydrology including how Reclamation calculates natural flows. The Reclamation modeling team then explains the approach for modeling future hydrology using ensembles and the approach to using hydrology in the Post-2026 Web Tool.

Integrated Technical Education Workgroup Session #2 - Colorado River Simulation System; May 3, 2023

The Colorado River Simulation System, also known as CRSS, is a comprehensive model of the Colorado River Basin and the primary tool for analyzing future river and reservoir conditions in a long-term planning context. It generates potential future conditions for many critical system components (e.g., reservoir elevations, releases, energy generation) at a monthly timestep for decades into the future. Learn more in the presentation.

Integrated Technical Education Workgroup Kick-off Meeting — December 7, 2022

Reclamation held the initial Integrated Technical Education Workgroup meeting on December 7, 2022. The meeting provided an overview of technical approaches of past efforts, an introduction of decision making under deep uncertainty, implementation of decision making under deep uncertainty in Post 2026 Operations, and future sessions.

Webinar Presentation

Section: Pre-Scoping

Source: <https://www.usbr.gov/ColoradoRiverBasin/post2026/pre-scope/index.html>

- Reclamation
- Colorado River Basin
- Colorado River Post 2026 Operations
- Colorado River Post 2026 Operations — Pre-Scoping

Pre-Scoping – Colorado River Post 2026 Operations

June 2022 Federal Register Notice Request for Input

To help develop operating strategies for post-2026, Reclamation published a Federal Register Notice on June 24, 2022 asking for public input in two specific areas:

- Suggested mechanisms for the anticipated NEPA process(es) to ensure that a wide range of Basin partners, stakeholders, and the general public can meaningfully engage and participate in the development of post-2026 operational strategies
- Potential substantive elements and strategies that should be considered for post-2026 operations and considered in the anticipated upcoming NEPA process(es)

The purpose of the Notice was to receive input on the process and substantive elements for post-2026 operations prior to the anticipated initiation in early 2023 of a formal process pursuant to the National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA). Reclamation was particularly interested in receiving specific recommendations that recognize the need for robust policies that withstand a broad range of future conditions and are not based on a single set of assumptions about water supply and demand; the current and emerging operational challenges resulting from low runoff conditions; and the need for engagement and inclusivity, including all Basin tribes and Mexico, in Colorado River decision-making processes.

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Pre-Scoping Comment Summary Report Webinar Reclamation held a webinar on Monday, January 30th to provide information on the Post-2026 Pre-Scoping Comment Summary Report. The report summarizes the pre-scoping comments received in response to the Federal Register Notice published in June 2022. [Learn more about the Pre-Scoping Process and Comments →](#)

[Webinar Presentation](#)

[Pre-Scoping Comment Summary Report](#)

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Summary of the Federal Register Notice Input Received The comment period for the Federal Register Notice extended from June 24 through September 1, 2022. During this timeframe, Reclamation received 135 unique comment letters from concerned citizens, more than 1,964 submittals of the BlueRibbon Coalition “Fill Lake Powell – the Path to 3588 ft” form letter, and 55 in-depth stakeholder letters signed by 81 unique stakeholders. [Learn more →](#)

[Materials and Webinar Videos](#)